

THE PAYSON MORNING SCROLL

MADE EXCLUSIVELY FOR THE MOGOLLON'S HEARTH GUESTS

"All the news worth knowing before the mead hall opens."

THE GREYBEARDS OF HIGH HROTHGAR — PUBLISHER & PROPRIETOR

PAYSON, ARIZONA · LOREDAS, THE 3RD OF FROSTFALL (SATURDAY, OCTOBER 3, 2026) · MORNING EDITION — VOL. 2610, No. 03
· PRICE: ONE SEPTIM



Henny basks on the sun-warmed deck, one wing raised against the glare — daring a single cloud to show itself.

SKIES O'ER THE HOLD

83° / 56°

Sunny

Sunrise 6:21 AM · Sunset 6:07 PM

Tomorrow — Sunny, 83/57

OVERHEARD LAST NIGHT

A traveler come up from the valley for fair day swears the bagpipes followed him all the way up the Beeline. The barkeep only shrugged: "Aye — they do that. They follow everybody home."

AROUND THE HOLDS · THE WEEK AHEAD

The Faire's Long Day; the Fair's Last Ride



Payson, Ariz.



The faire's long day and the county fair's last ride: caber-tossing and torchlight revelry on the fairways, bulls at dusk in the arena.

GOOD morrow, wayfarers, and mind the sun — Lore-das dawns bright as a polished septim over the Rim! Frostfall settles in proper now — the lowlanders call it "October", a name that lands like a dropped shield — and the Hold answers with the longest day of the season: the North Inch Renaissance Faire runs nine of the morning clock to nine of the evening, caber and claymore by daylight and torchlight revelry after, while the 72nd Northern Gila County Fair takes its final bow at the Event Center with bulls at dusk and fiddles ringing. Two fairs, one Hold, and no excuse to sit by the fire. Below: the day's doings in every Hold, the days ahead, the

Hearth's own quests, a new Merchant of the Hold, and a tale from the treeline.

HAPPENING IN THE HOLDS TODAY

• Payson

— **North Inch Renaissance Faire** — the faire's long day, 9 AM–9 PM, Payson Golf Course, 1504 W Country Club Dr. Scottish artisans, combat demonstrations, Highland games, music, and evening torchlight merriment in the inaugural Highland village. \$8 adults, \$4 children; active-duty military free.

— **72nd Annual Northern Gila County Fair** — final day at the Payson Event Center, 1400 S Beeline Hwy; gates 9 AM, the fair wraps tonight about 10 PM. Pro bull riding, ranch rodeo, goat roping, the Junior Livestock Auction, and the Arizona State Champion Fiddle Festival. Admission \$3–\$5.



Pine-Strawberry

— **Pine-Strawberry October Craft Fair** — the 36th annual fall craft fair, 8 AM–5 PM at the Pine-Strawberry Community Center Ramada, 3886 N Highway 87, Pine. Handmade goods from Rim Country crafters on smoke-free, alcohol-free grounds; continues Sunday 8 AM–4 PM.

— **Kilted Spirit Trio** — Celtic music at noon at the Lodge at 5600, Pine — a fitting soundtrack for faire weekend among the pines.



Camp Verde

— **Verde Valley Farmers Market** — the final market of the 2026 season, 8–11 AM at the town ramada, 75 E Hollamon St. The last chance this year for Verde Valley produce and local goods before the stalls close for the season.

— **Twice Nice Fall Thrifty** — community day 10 AM–2 PM at Twice Nice Thriftique, 527 S Main St. Donation raffles, food trucks, and live music by the sister duo Kaleidoscope Redrocks, with a live radio remote.



Sedona

— **Liverpool Acoustic: Beatles Unplugged** — 7 PM at the Mary D. Fisher Theatre, 2030 W SR 89A. \$30 advance, \$35 at the door, with a meet-and-greet after the show.

— **'Cosi fan tutte' — Met Live Opera** — live simulcast 10 AM (pre-opera talk 9 AM) at the Mary D. Fisher Theatre; \$28 general, \$25 members, \$18 students. Encore Wednesday 2 PM.

— **Sky Rock Sedona — Live Music** — 6–9 PM at Sky Rock Inn, live music on the hilltop with red-rock views.



Prescott

— **42nd Folk Music Festival** — back after seven years! Gates 9 AM, music 10 AM–5 PM at Sharlot Hall Museum, 415 W Gurley St. More than 50 musicians on four stages, food trucks, and a Kid Zone; \$15 non-members, members and children under 9 free. Bring lawn chairs.

— **Prescott Area Artist Studio Tour** — free self-guided tour, 10 AM–4 PM daily through Sunday. 74 artists across 52 private studios plus three art centers, with live demonstrations.

— **Bees Fall Classic Car Auction** — the live auction kicks off 11 AM at Pine Ridge Marketplace, 3106 Gateway Blvd; gates 8 AM, online live bidding available. Free admission and parking.

THE DAYS AHEAD

• Sundas, 4th of Frostfall (Sun, Oct. 4)

— **North Inch Renaissance Faire** — final day, 9 AM–5

PM at the Payson Golf Course, 1504

W Country Club Dr. The last chance to walk the inaugural Highland village — artisans' marketplace, two stages of entertainment, the Royal Court of Mary Queen of Scots, and combat demonstrations — before the tents come down. \$8 adults, \$4 children.

— **Pine-Strawberry October Craft Fair** — the 36th annual fair wraps 8 AM–4 PM at the Pine-Strawberry Community Center Ramada, 3886 N Highway 87, Pine. 80+ booths of handmade goods and food on smoke-free, alcohol-free grounds.

— **Sedona Community Farmers Market** — the winter season begins, 11 AM–3 PM at the Wells Fargo lot, 2201 W SR 89A, West Sedona. Local and regional harvest, artisan goods, and live music; dogs welcome on leash.

— **Dogtoberfest & Adopt-a-Thon** — 10 AM–3 PM at Watson Lake Park, Prescott. A free dog-centric festival: look-alike, trick, and costume contests, dog races, the Bark for Life Walk, and artisan vendors with food trucks. \$5 parking benefits the Yavapai County Sheriff's Posse.



Dogtoberfest at Watson Lake: costumes, contests, and very good dogs.

• Morndas, 5th of Frostfall (Mon, Oct. 5)

— **Mobile Business Services @ Payson** — the Arizona Secretary of State's mobile office visits the Payson Public Library, 328 N McLane Rd, 9 AM–3 PM (lunch break noon–1), for business filings and state services. Repeats Wednesday.

• **Tirdas, 6th of Frostfall (Tue, Oct. 6)**

— **Trail Day Volunteer Build** — 7 AM–noon off Highway 87 just before Pine (parking at the large circular dirt turnout). Pine-Strawberry Fuel Reduction volunteers clear brush, move rocks, and shape trails that double as fire-access routes; bring water, gloves, and sturdy shoes, tools provided. Email trails@psfuelreduction.org for directions.

• **Middas, 7th of Frostfall (Wed, Oct. 7)**

— **Breakfast Club: Tonto Search & Rescue** — 7:30–8:30 AM at Noley's — Books, Art & Whatnot, 103 E State Highway 260, Payson. An informative breakfast with Tonto Search & Rescue, hosted by the Rim Country Regional Chamber; \$15 per person, free for chamber members.

• **Fredas, 9th of Frostfall (Fri, Oct. 9)**

— **Sky Rock Sedona — Live Music** — weekend live music returns to Sky Rock Sedona, 6–9 PM, with sunset skies over the red rocks. A reliable Friday evening out in West Sedona.

A SPECIAL SPREAD

The Faire's Long Day



The long day: caber by daylight, revelry by torchlight.

This is the day the Hold has been waiting for all week: the North Inch Renaissance Faire's long day, nine of the morning clock to nine of the evening, on the fairways of the Payson Golf Course.

Within the palisade: Scottish artisans at their crafts, combat demonstrations, Highland games, axe throwing and archery, music and storytelling across two stages, and the Royal Court of Mary Queen of Scots in session. By daylight it is caber and claymore; after dusk the torches come out and the village revels into the evening — the one night of the year the Hold turns Highland after dark.

The crowd, mind you, dresses Nord; the Scotsmen are but a traveling few — a lone piper and his queer wind-device, wailing like a heartbroken mammoth (other travelers have called it a 'bagpipie').

Payson Golf Course, 1504 W Country Club Dr · Today 9 AM–9 PM · \$8 adults, \$4 children; active-duty military free · northinchrf.com

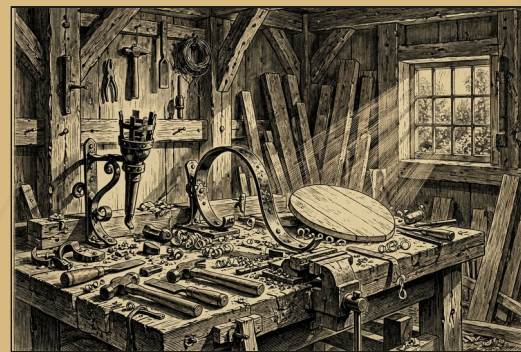
Why go: The one day of the year the Highland village stays open past dusk — caber-tossing by daylight, torchlight revelry after.

QUESTS OF THE HEARTH

Quests awaiting:

- ☐ **Print the torch sconces** — Due Loredas, Oct. 3 — print two torches plus the socket test piece; test-fit the bulb and socket first.
- ☐ **Design & prep the torch sconces** — Overdue since Sept. 26 — measure the flame bulb and socket, then find or design the wall-torch sconce model.
- ☐ **Finish & install the torches** — Due Oct. 10 — paint faux wrought iron or wood, then UV sealant; breaker OFF for the install.

Due Loredas: the torch sconces must print today — the Hearth's torchlight waits on thee.



The craftsman's bench: torch sconces on the rise, tools at the ready.

MERCHANT OF THE HOLD

Wild Iris Coffee House · Prescott



Wild Iris Coffee House, where the courtyard overlooks the creek.

Wild Iris Coffee House is a locally owned coffee house and café on South Granite Street in Prescott, pouring espresso drinks brewed to wake the sleepiest traveler and serving pastries baked from scratch on the premises, plus light lunch fare — quiche, paninis, and sandwiches. The signature pour is the ‘Bee's Knees,’ a cappuccino with Arizona honey and lavender; the thing to order is the homemade breakfast sandwich on a scratch-baked biscuit. The secluded dog-friendly courtyard, with its fountain overlooking Granite Creek, is a fine spot to linger over a cup.

“It's so nice to get away from the national chains and relax at a homegrown establishment. Plus it was toasty warm which was great after standing in the chilly afternoon overcast during the parade. But better than that was the tasty drinks and relaxed setting.” — a [TripAdvisor review](#)

124 S Granite St (Ste E), Prescott, AZ 86303 — open daily 6 AM–6 PM; (928) 778-5155; \$\$ (~\$10–25 per person); the dog-friendly courtyard overlooks Granite Creek, and free Wi-Fi makes it a popular work spot — it can get crowded on busy days. · [their scrying-mirror page](#) (other travelers call it a ‘website’)

Why the Hearth sends you:

Prescott's own homegrown coffee hall — where Valley Dwellers trade the lowland heat for a cool courtyard, a honey-lavender cappuccino, and pastries still warm from the oven. On the drive from the Hearth, Montezuma Castle's cliff dwelling rises just off the trail near Camp Verde — worth a rein-pull and a likeness snared in thy pocket-glass (other travelers have called it a ‘celliephone’).

TALES FROM THE TREELINE

FLIGHT SCHOOL



Flurry comes in for a landing — Jethro waves him down.

On a blazing Loredas morning, the kind of bright where the shadows themselves squinted, Jethro (the Mogollon Monster) announced that Flurry needed landing lessons.

Flurry (a young ice-breathing dragon) flies in a fine straight line, Jethro explained, which is the easy part. The hard part is the arriving. Ever since the rain-barrel incident his tail has had a kink, so he flies in zigzags and lands wherever the wind argues him into — last week that was Gus the orc baker's pie-cooling rack, and the week before, Mabel's herb bed, which is still not over it.

So Jethro laid out a landing strip of pine needles in the sunny clearing, planted two tiny signal flags, and waved Flurry in. Earl (an elk) stood by as the tower, enormous antlers held high, calling the altitude in his most official voice. “Two tail-lengths! One! Flare!”

Flurry flared. Flurry zigged. Flurry zagged — and set down neat as you please in the middle of the strip, wings folded, looking enormously pleased with himself.

Jethro wept with pride. Earl logged it in the bark ledger: one good landing. Then the wind shifted, and Flurry's victory lap ended in Gus's pie rack again.

One out of two, the forest agreed, is a personal best.

Printed with pride in Payson, in the shadow of the Rim · Set in hot metal by Dude, Bard of the Morning Scroll · May your Loredas be free of spiders, Clay.

